MY STORY

How I Built CLTH.Y with AI — My Journey from Scratch

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The idea, and how I worked with AI

I started with an empty folder and a clear idea — a Korean-style colour analysis that ends in real outfits — and built the whole working product, live on the internet, by directing an AI step by step.

My job was to decide what the product should be, give the AI clear instructions and good reference material, test what came back, and say exactly what was wrong. The AI's job was to build, and to tell me honestly what it could and could not do.

My journey in stages

In about a dozen rounds I went from a written brief to a live website that analyses a person's colours and dresses them in real, in-stock outfits.

STAGE	WHAT I ASKED THE AI	WHAT CAME OUT AND WHAT I LEARNED
1. The brief	One long, numbered brief: the folders, eight screens, the colour palette, fonts, and a step-by-step log file (steps.md) so the build could be repeated anywhere.	A first working website. A clear brief gave a clear first draft.
2. One folder, real AI	Remove the separate folders. Add AI that reads the customer's photos as a Korean colour master, then a second AI step that designs outfits from the stores they chose with exact product links, never search pages.	One project folder and two AI steps. The “no search links” rule shaped everything that followed.
3. Switching tools	Use my OpenRouter key instead of the first AI service.	The AI was swapped over. We found my account only allowed Google Gemini models, and designed around that.
4. Going public	Push the code to GitHub, then host it on Vercel.	A live website and a code repository I own.
5. Photos and intake	Four photo slots with example photos, a live camera, remove the location, budget tier and style genres, add an Others occasion.	A friendlier first screen that collects only what matters.
6. Accurate colours	Use my own matrix PDF and two YouTube videos as the reference, and “do not hallucinate”.	Colours are now calculated from measured skin tone and a six-clue undertone vote, and stay the same for the same photos.

7. Real shopping	No out-of-stock items, keep inside my budget of ₹1,500–₹50,000, make an airport look really suit an airport, make it faster.	Stock, price and budget are checked on the store pages, and the AI plans around the occasion.
8. Try-on	Put the exact clothes from the links on the real person with a white background, automatically.	An AI-drawn picture of the customer wearing the chosen items.
9. Easier reading	The report is overwhelming: use a dropdown, plain words.	One topic at a time, in everyday language.
10. Look and feel	A minimal Korean-salon home page with an animated fabric swatch book; plain fabric, no brand names; remove Mix & Match.	A calm, believable home page.
11. Documents	A user-journey document in simple language, then a PDF, then this story.	Clear write-ups I can share.

The moments my feedback made it better

The biggest improvements came from me spotting a real problem and saying it plainly, often with a screenshot.

WHAT I NOTICED	WHAT I SAID	WHAT CHANGED
Everyone got the same colours	“Every individual is getting the same colour analysis”	Colours are now worked out from each person's measured skin tone and a season wheel, not guessed.
Colours kept changing	“Why are the power colours changing all the time?”	The AI now answers consistently, the face is found by a fixed method, and the same photos reuse the same report.
Links could not be trusted	“Exact link of the item, not the website or a search”	Only product pages that really appeared in the search are kept, and they are checked live.
Sold-out clothes	“Do not give out-of-stock products”	Every page is checked for stock, and sold-out items are swapped for in-stock alternatives.
A blank wardrobe page	A screenshot of the error	The cause was found: the AI account was out of credit. Looks are also searched more thoroughly now.
The report was overwhelming	“Give a drop-down box, easy to understand”	One topic at a time, in plain words.
The try-on did not look real	“Put the real clothing on the real person”	The exact items are drawn on the customer's own photo, on white.
The swatch book looked fake	“Make it look real, make the fabric plain, don't mention the brand”	Plain matte cloth, a believable book, no brand names.

How I asked: habits that worked

Six habits show up again and again in how I worked with the AI.

1. **Start with a written brief.** Folders, screens, colours, fonts and a numbered step log, all up front, so the AI built the right thing first time.
2. **Say what must never happen.** “No search links”, “don't hallucinate”, “no out-of-stock”, “don't change the budget”. Clear rules became checks built into the product.
3. **Give real references.** My own matrix PDF, two YouTube videos, a photo of real swatch cards. The AI copied the method instead of inventing one.
4. **Test it and show the problem.** I used the live site, sent screenshots and said “why is it showing this?” That led to the true causes, such as the empty AI credit.
5. **Change one thing at a time.** Small, specific requests (“make it say Analysing”, “remove the location”) were done quickly and cleanly.
6. **Keep a record.** The step log and the two documents mean anyone can repeat or explain the build.

What to keep doing, and what comes next

The product works end to end, and the next steps are practical ones rather than new ideas.

- **Keep the method.** Brief, rules, references, test, screenshot, fix.
- **Top up the AI account.** It is almost empty, and every analysis, outfit search and try-on picture costs a little.
- **Test with real people.** Ask friends with very different skin tones to try it, and note any result that looks wrong. That is how the season rules get better.
- **Add more checkable stores.** Today only some stores allow live stock checks. A paid scraping service could cover the rest.
- **Be open about the limits.** The try-on is an AI picture and colours depend on photo quality. Saying so builds trust.
